



Detecting glucose in saliva

A biochip developed which could detect the glucose levels in water can now detect the same in saliva too <http://dgit.in/GlucoseDetector>



Solar panels on your rooftop

Seeing very few people adopting solar energy for their homes, Elon Musk wants to build cool looking solar panels <http://dgit.in/CoolSolarPanels>

Feature

as the pre sale service,” says Mehul Jobanputra, Desidime, on warranty issues.

Just a gimmick or are they actually serious?

Brands discouraging customers to buy their products from e-commerce websites is understandable to some extent. Online stores usually offer products at lower price as compared to physical stores – a key feature that’s been driving the e-commerce sales in India.

That said, these brands have spent massively on setting up distribution and channel partners across the country. Physical stores in India have taken a huge hit due to the surge in online sales. It certainly appears to be one of the main reasons for brands asking users not to buy products from e-commerce websites.

“It may be hurting the brands to a certain extent. But it is also giving them access to newer customers who may or may not have brought their products in the first place,” opines Jobanputra.

Formal tie-ups: perhaps an unlikely solution?

Trend of exclusive tie ups has picked up of late. The Flipkart-Motorola exclusive tie-up for Moto G and Moto E smartphones certainly gives a peek at the way e-commerce may evolve with ever-changing customer preferences. Formal agreements, however, are a different matter, because smartphone companies look to put a check to the huge price discrepancies between products sold online and offline.

What this means is that e-commerce sites will, by tying up, be agreeing to sell at a brand-decided cost, which means they can’t offer products cheaper than other online/offline stores, and thus lose the advantage of offering a good deal. Also imagine if you were getting the same product at the same price online as you would at your local store, why would you buy online, wait for delivery, hope you get the right product, hope it works, etc., when you could walk over to the corner shop and walk away with a perfectly good product for the same price?

In conclusion

First and foremost priority should be protecting customers’ interests. While smartphone companies have to acknowledge changing customer preferences – who have greater inclination towards online research and shopping and comparison, e-commerce web sites have to address the warranty concerns by educating customers and by prominently display warranty and service related information.

As a user, since e-commerce web sites are a dime a dozen, you need to research more carefully before buying; this includes reading through user reviews, asking for information about manufacturer warranty and service, and checking the credibility of the website or seller (in case of an online marketplace).

Obviously we will be here to help you through this as well, so remember to use our Forum (digit.in/forum) and our various social networking channels to get in touch with us and the rest of the Digit community to safeguard your own interests.

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